15.081 Math Programming class notes

Erich Trieschman

2025 Fall semester

Contents

1 Linear algebra and set review **1**

2 Linear programming geometry **3**
2.1 Linear programming formulation tricks . . . 4

3 Simplex method **4**

4 Duality **6**
4.1 Weak and strong duality, complementary slackness . . . 7
4.1.1 Strong duality . . . 7
4.1.2 Complementary slackness . . . 7
4.1.3 Strict complementary slackness . . . 7
4.1.4 Primal-dual outcome possibilities . . . 7
4.2 Degeneracy . . . 8
4.3 Farkas' lemma . . . 8
4.3.1 Farkas' lemma proof examples . . . 9
4.4 Separating hyperplanes to duality . . . 10
4.5 Cones and extreme rays . . . 10
4.5.1 Extreme rays . . . 10
4.5.2 Resolution theorem . . . 10

5 Sensitivity analysis **11**

6 Large scale optimization **11**
6.1 Dantzig-Wolfe decomposition. . . . 12
6.2 Benders decomposition . . . 12

7 Network flows **13**

8 Ellipsoid and interior point methods **15**
8.1 Ellipsoid method . . . 15
8.2 Separation problem to solve exponentially many constraints . . . 15
8.3 Interior point methods . . . 15
8.3.1 Affine scaling . . . 15
8.3.2 Barrier method and central path . . . 16

1 Linear algebra and set review

Proof formats **(Set inclusion)** Prove $P = Q \implies$ Prove $(P \subseteq Q)$ and $(Q \subseteq P)$. **(Contradiction)** Prove $A \Rightarrow B \implies$ Assume A and $\neg B$ and find contradiction. (**Contrapositive**) Prove $A \Rightarrow B \implies$ Prove $\neg B \Rightarrow \neg A$. **(Induction)** Prove $A(n) \implies$ *Base:* prove $A(0)$, *Assumption:* assume $A(n)$; *Induction:* derive $A(n+1)$.

Matrix formats $A = \begin{bmatrix} A_1 & A_2 & \dots & A_n \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} a_1^\top & \dots & a_m^\top \end{bmatrix}^\top$, $Ax = \sum_i A_i x_i = \begin{bmatrix} a_1^\top x & \dots & a_m^\top x \end{bmatrix}^\top$

$A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ **invertible** $\iff \operatorname{rank}(A) = n \iff$ linearly independent columns/rows $\iff Ax = b$ unique x

Sherman-Morrison-Woodbury formula for $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}, U, V \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times k}$ (special case: $u, v \in \mathbb{R}^n$)

$$(A+UV^\top)^{-1} = A^{-1} - A^{-1}U(I+V^\top A^{-1}U)^{-1}V^\top A^{-1} \qquad (A+uv^\top)^{-1} = A^{-1} - \frac{A^{-1}uv^\top A^{-1}}{(1+v^\top A^{-1}u)}$$

Polyhedron A set $P = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ax \geq b\}$. To **test boundedness** use contradiction: Suppose $\exists d \neq 0$ such that $x + \lambda d \in P\ \forall \lambda \geq 0$, usually arriving at contradiction that $d = 0$.

Distance The shortest path from point x_0 to plane $a^\top x = b$ is orthogonal to the plane. Write as $x = x_0 - t * a : b = a^\top x = a^\top(x_0 - t * a) = a^\top x_0 - t \left\|a\right\|_2^2 \implies t = (b - a^\top x_0)/\left\|a\right\|_2^2$.

Projection $\Pi_k(S) = \{\pi_k(x) \mid x \in S\}$ where $\pi_k(x) = \pi_k(x_1, \ldots, x_n) = (x_1, \ldots, x_k)$. S nonempty $\iff$ $\Pi_k(S)$ nonempty. **Corrolary** For $P \subset \mathbb{R}^{n+k}$ a polyhedron, then $\{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid \exists y \in \mathbb{R}^k \text{ with } (x,y) \in P\}$ is a polyhedron.

Fourier-Motzkin elimination Tradeoff of decrease in dimension for increase in constraints:

$$P = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid a_i^\top x \geq b_i, i \in [m]\} = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid a_{in}x_n \geq -\sum_j a_{ij}x_j + b_i, i \in [m]\}$$

$$Q = \left\{ x \in \mathbb{R}^{n-1} \mid \begin{cases} d_j + f_j^\top \overline{x} \geq d_i + f_i^\top \overline{x} & a_{jn} < 0, a_{jn} > 0 \\ 0 \geq d_k + f_k^\top \overline{x} & a_{kn} = 0 \end{cases} \right\} = \Pi_{n-1}(P)$$

Elimination algorithm for solving LP: Lift optimization problem: $\max_{\{x|Ax\geq b\}} c^\top x \Rightarrow P' = \{(x, x_0) \mid Ax \geq b, c^\top x = x_0\}$. Use elimination to arrive at $Q = \{x_0 \mid \alpha_i x_0 \leq \beta_i\}$; the optimization becomes $\min_{\{x_0|x\in Q\}}$.

Basis for subset S is a collection $\mathcal{X} = \{x^{(0)}, x^{(1)}, \ldots\} \subset S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ such that (i) $\text{span}(\mathcal{X}) = \{y \mid y = \sum_i a_i x^{(i)}\} = S$ and (ii) $\mathcal{X}$ is linearly independent.

Constructing a basis Given span S of vectors $x^1, \ldots, x^K$ has dimension m and $x^1, \ldots, x^k$ linearly indepenent. We can form a basis by starting with those vectors. Since for $k < m$ we know at least one vector in $x^{k+1}, \ldots, x^K$ is linearly independent from the original set, choose that one.

Convex function $f(\lambda x + (1-\lambda)y) \leq \lambda f(x) + (1-\lambda)f(y),\ \forall f : \mathbb{R}^n \mapsto \mathbb{R},\ \forall x, y \in \mathbb{R}^n,\ \forall \lambda \in [0,1]$
The max of convex functions is convex:

$$\begin{aligned} f(\lambda x + (1-\lambda)y) &= \max_{i\in[m]} f_i(\lambda x + (1-\lambda)y) \leq \max_{i\in[m]} (\lambda f_i(x) + (1-\lambda)f_i(y)) \\ &\leq \max_{i\in[m]} \lambda f_i(x) + \max_{i\in[m]} (1-\lambda)f_i(y) = \lambda f(x) + (1-\lambda)f(y) \end{aligned}$$

Convex set $S \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ such that $\lambda x + (1-\lambda)y \in S, \forall x, y \in S, \lambda \in [0,1]$. A **convex combination** of a finite number of elements of convex set, S also belongs to that set. **(Proof with induction)** Base case: given for 2 elements by definition. Assume step k, then

$$\sum_{i=1}^{k+1} \lambda_i x^i = \lambda_{k+1}x^{k+1} + (1-\lambda_{k+1})\sum_{i=1}^{k} \frac{\lambda_i}{1-\lambda_{k+1}} x^i \qquad \text{with } \lambda_i \geq 0, \sum_i \lambda_i = 1,\ \left(\sum_{i=1}^{k} \frac{\lambda_i}{1-\lambda_{k+1}} x^i\right) \in S$$

Caratheodory theorem Let $C = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^m \mid x = A\lambda, \lambda \geq 0\}, A \in \mathbb{R}^{m\times n}$. Then $\forall x \in C,\ \exists \lambda^* \geq 0$ with $|\text{supp}(\lambda^*)| \leq m$. **(Proof sketch)** Suppose $|\text{supp}(\lambda^*)| > m \implies \exists d \in \mathcal{N}(A)$ such that $\text{supp}(d) \subseteq \text{supp}(\lambda)$ since rows of $A_{\text{supp}(\lambda)}$ linearly dependent. Can move along d while $A(\lambda + \theta d) = x$. Do this until one value of λ is driven to 0. **(Extension)** Let $P = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^m \mid x = A\lambda, \lambda \geq 0, \mathbf{1}^\top\lambda = 1\}, A \in \mathbb{R}^{m\times n}$. Then $\forall x \in P,\ \exists \lambda^* \geq 0$ with $|\text{supp}(\lambda^*)| \leq m+1$. **(Proof sketch)** Define $\tilde{A} = [A^\top, \mathbf{1}]^\top \in \mathbb{R}^{(m+1)\times n}$ and use earlier proof. **(Dimension elimination in general)** (i) Identify or suppose linear dependence of rows/columns of A_I, (ii) choose d such that $Ad = 0$, (iii) move along d until the dimension is reduced using simplex step size.

Affine subspace $y \in S = \{x \mid Ax = b\} \iff (x - x^0) \in S_0 = \{y \mid Ay = 0\},\ \forall x \in S$ and for fixed $x^0 \in S$

Affine subspace and dimension. Let $S = \{x \mid Ax \geq b\}$ and fix any x^0 with $Ax^0 \geq b$. Then $S = \{x^0 + y \mid y \in S_0\}$, $S_0 = \{y \mid Ay \geq 0\}$. The affine hull of S is $\text{aff}(S) = \{x_0 + \text{span}(x - x_0 : x \in S)\}$. Its dimension is $\dim(S) = \dim(\text{aff}(S)) = n - \text{rank}(A_{I_=})$, where $I_= = \{i \mid a_i^\top x = b, \forall x \in S\}$.

2 Linear programming geometry

Extreme point $x \in P$ such that $\nexists y, z \in P,\ \lambda \in [0,1]$ such that $x = \lambda y + (1-\lambda)z$ and $x \neq y, z$. **Vertex** $x \in P$ such that $\exists\, c$ where $c^\top x < c^\top y,\ \forall\, y \in P, y \neq x$. **Basic feasible solution** A **basic solution** satisfies $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$ such that i) all equality constraints of P are active, ii) of all active constraints of P, n are linearly independent. A **basic feasible solution** is a basic solution with $x \in P$. To **construct a basic solution**, choose m linearly independent columns of A, A_B, let $x_j = 0\ \forall j \notin B$, and solve system of equations, $Ax = b$ for unknowns $x_B = A_B^{-1} b$

Extreme point $\Rightarrow$ BFS: Let $I = \{i \mid a_i^\top x = b_i\}$. Suppose $x \in P$ not a BFS, then normals $\{a_i\}_{i \in I}$ do not span $\mathbb{R}^n \implies \exists\, d \neq 0 \in \mathbb{R}^n$ such that $a_i^\top d = 0 \forall\, i \in I$. Consider points $y = x + \epsilon d$, $z = x - \epsilon d$. For $i \in I, a_i^\top y = a_i^\top x + \epsilon a_i^\top d = b_i$ so constraints remain active. For $j \notin I$ we have $a_j^\top x > b_j$. Let $\bar{\epsilon} = \min\left\{ \frac{a_j^\top x - b_j}{|a_j^\top d|} \mid j \notin I,\ a_j^\top d \neq 0 \right\} > 0$. Then $\forall \epsilon \in [0, \bar{\epsilon}],\ j \notin I,\ a_j^\top y = a_j^\top x + \epsilon a_j^\top d \geq a_j^\top x - |\epsilon a_j^\top d| > a_j^\top x - (a_j^\top x - b_j) = b_j$. Hence $y, z \in P$. Since $d \neq 0,\ y \neq z,\ x = \frac{1}{2}(y+z)$, a nontrivial convex combination of two distinct feasible points. Contradiction $\square$

Vertex $\Rightarrow$ Extreme point: Suppose $x \in P$ a vertex. Then $\exists\, c$ such that $\forall y, z \in P \setminus \{x\}$, $c^\top x < c^\top z$ and $c^\top x < c^\top y$. This implies $\forall \lambda \in [0,1],\ c^\top x < c^\top(\lambda y + (1-\lambda)z) \implies x \neq \lambda y + (1-\lambda)z$ $\square$

BFS $\Rightarrow$ Vertex: Let $x \in P$ a BFS, $I = \{i \mid a_i^\top x = b_i\}$, and $c = \sum_{i \in I} a_i$. Then $c^\top x = \sum_{i \in I} a_i^\top x = \sum_{i \in I} b_i$. Furthermore, $\forall y \in P$, $c^\top y = \sum_{i \in I} a_i^\top y \geq \sum_{i \in I} b_i$. This shows x optimal to problem of minimizing $c^\top x$. x a BFS $\implies$ there are n linearly independent constraints active at x and x is the unique solution to the system of equations $a_i^\top x = b_i, i \in I \implies x$ is the unique minimizer of $c^\top y, \forall y \in P \implies x$ is a vertex.

BFS properties and exercises

- **Finite number of BFS:** For $P = \{x \mid Ax \geq b\}$ with m linearly independent rows of A, there are at most $\binom{n}{m}$ BFS
- **BFS implies $x_{j \notin I} = 0$:** Consider $Ax = b, x \geq 0$ with $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ with m linearly independent rows. x a BFS $\iff$ $Ax = b$ and $\exists$ m indices B indices such that A_B are linearly independent. Then $Ax = A_B x_B = b$ and if $j \notin B \implies x_j = 0$.
- **If standard form and all BFS nondegenerate** then support of any feasible x is $\geq m$: Use resolution theorem and note i) support of convex combination of nondegenerate extreme points always $\geq m$, ii) linear positive combination of extreme rays is nonnegative.
- **Standard form polyhedra defines $(n-m)$-dimensional affine subspace intersected with the positive orthant.** Let $P = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^3 \mid Ax = b, x \geq 0\}$ and $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ has m linearly independent rows. If $n = m + 1$, then P has at most 2 BFS.
- $\min_{\{x \mid x_1 = 0, x \geq 0\}} x_1$ shows: (i) there may be optimal solutions with support $> m$ (E.g., $(0, x_2, x_3)$), (ii) If there are several optimal solutions, there need not exist two optimal BFS (i.e., only BFS is $(0,0,0)$)
- $\min_{\{x \mid x_1 + x_2 = 1,\ x \geq 0\}} \max\{x_1 - x_2,\ x_2 - x_1\}$ shows: this problem need not have an optimal BFS $\in P$ $(x^* = (\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}))$

Existence of extreme points. For nonempty $P = \{x \mid Ax \geq b\}$ the following are equivalent: (a) P has an extreme point; (b) P contains no line; (c) A contains n linearly independent rows.

- **(b)$\Rightarrow$(a)** Pick any $x \in P$. If x is a BFS, done. Otherwise, let $I = \{i \mid a_i^\top x = b_i\}$ be the active set and note that A_I has linearly dependent rows. Thus $\exists\, d \neq 0$ with $A_I d = 0$. Since P contains no line, the ray $\{x + \lambda d\}$ cannot stay in $P\ \forall\ \lambda$. Hence at some endpoint λ^* of the feasible interval, a new constraint $j \notin I$ becomes tight, $a_j^\top(x + \lambda^* d) = b_j$. Because $a_j^\top d \neq 0$ while $A_I d = 0$, a_j is linearly independent of $\{a_i\}_{i \in I}$. Set $x \leftarrow x + \lambda^* d$ and update $I \leftarrow I \cup \{j\}$. Each iteration strictly increases $rank(A_I)$; after at most n steps we obtain n independent active constraints.
- **(a)$\Rightarrow$(c)** $x \in P$ extreme point $\Rightarrow$ x a BFS $\Rightarrow$ $\exists n$ constraints active at x $\Rightarrow$ corresponding rows of A linearly independent

- **(c)⇒(b)** Contradiction: suppose $\{x + \lambda d : \lambda \in \mathbb{R}\} \subset P$ with $d \neq 0$. Feasibility for all λ implies $A(x + \lambda d) \geq b \quad \forall \lambda \implies Ad = 0$. If A has n linearly independent rows, they span $\mathbb{R}^n$ so $Ad = 0 \Rightarrow d = 0$
- **Corollaries.** A bounded polyhedron has an extreme point. The nonnegative orthant $\{x \geq 0\}$ contains no line; hence any polyhedron in standard form (contained in $\{x \geq 0\}$) contains no line.

Existence of optimal extreme point. For $\min_{\{x|Ax\geq b\}} c^\top x$, either the cost is $-\infty$ or an optimal extreme point exists. **(Proof)** Let $x \in P$ with active set $I = \{i \mid a_i^\top x = b_i\}$ of rank $k < n \implies \exists d \neq 0$ with $Ad = 0$; choose sign so $c^\top d \leq 0$. Consider $x + \lambda d$. If feasible for all $\lambda > 0$, then $c^\top(x + \lambda d) \to -\infty$. Otherwise let $\lambda^* > 0$ be the first point where a new constraint $j \notin I$ becomes active, $a_j^\top(x + \lambda^* d) = b_j$. Set $x \leftarrow x + \lambda^* d$. Then $c^\top x$ does not increase and rank(I) increases by 1. Repeat at most $n - k$ times to obtain n independent active constraints; the resulting point is a BFS and thus an optimal extreme point. □

Unique optimum. For $\min_{\{x|Ax=b,x\geq 0\}} c^\top x$ with optimal BFS x^* and reduced costs $\bar{c}_N$, x^* is the unique optimum $\iff I = \{i \in N : \bar{c}_i = 0\} = \emptyset$ (Dual nondegeneracy). **(Proof ⇐)** Contradiction: Suppose $\exists y \neq x^*$ with $c^\top y = c^\top x^*$. Let $d = y - x^*$; then $Ad = A_B d_B + A_N d_N = 0$ so $d_B = -A_B^{-1} A_N d_N$. Since $0 = c^\top d = c_B^\top d_B + c_N^\top d_N = \bar{c}_N^\top d_N$. $I = \emptyset \implies \bar{c}_N > 0 \Rightarrow d_N = 0 \Rightarrow d_B = 0$, so $y = x^*$, contradiction. **(Proof ⇒)** Contradiction: Suppose $I \neq \emptyset$, and pick $j \in I$ with $\bar{c}_j = 0$. Let $x(\theta) = x^* + \theta d$, $d_N = e_j$, $d_B = -A_B^{-1} A_N e_j$. For small $\theta > 0$, $x(\theta)$ is feasible and $c^\top x(\theta) = c^\top x^* + \theta \bar{c}_j = c^\top x^*$. So a second optimum exists, contradiction

Full dimensional. Polyhedron $P = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ax \geq b\}$ (a) is full dimensional (has positive volume) $\iff$ (b) $\exists\ x \in P : Ax > b \iff$ (c) $n + 1$ extreme points of P do not lie on a common hyperplane. **(Proof (a)⇒(c))** Contrapositive: observe that all extreme points must lie on the same hyperplane, H (n affinely independent points define a hyperplane). The convex hull of all extreme points, P_S, has dimension $n - 1$. $dim(P) = dim(P_S)$, so $dim(P) = n - 1$. **(Proof (c)⇒(b))** For each constraint, $\exists\ x^{(i)} : a_i^\top x > b$. Form a convex combination of $x^{(j)}\ \forall j$. This point is (i) feasible and (2) in the interior of P. **(Proof (b)⇒(a))** Choose interior point x_0. Distance from point to each constraint is $d_i = (a_i^\top x_0 - b_i)/||a_i||_2$. Note $d_i > 0\ \forall\ i \Rightarrow \epsilon = \min_i d_i > 0$. So ball $B(x_0, \epsilon) = \{y \mid (y - x_0)^\top (y - x_0) \leq \epsilon\} \subseteq P$ has full dimension.

2.1 Linear programming formulation tricks

Convert any problem to standard form WLOG, all rows of A are linearly independent. This can be proved by showing two-way containment between set with and without dependent rows of A.

$$\max_{\{x|a_i^\top x\geq b_i, a_j^\top x\leq b_j\}} c^\top x \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \max_{\{x|a_i^\top(x^+-x^-)\geq b_i, a_j^\top(x^+-x^-)\leq b_j, x^+\geq 0, x^-\geq 0\}} c^\top(x^+ - x^-) \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \min_{\{x|a_i^\top y - s_i = b_i\ a_j^\top y + s_j = b_j, y, s\geq 0\}} -c^\top y$$

Problems involving maximum over functions

$$\min_{\{x|Ax\geq b\}} \max_{i\in[m]} (c_i^\top x + d_i) \qquad \Longrightarrow \qquad \min_{\{x|Ax\geq b,\ z\geq c_i^\top x + d_i\}} z$$

Problems involving absolute value At optimal, for each i we must have either $x_i^+ = 0$ or $x_i^- = 0$. Otherwise, we could change both by same amount, preserve feasibility, and reduce cost.

$$\min_{\{x|Ax\geq b\}} \sum_i c_i|x_i| \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \min_{\{x|Ax\geq b, x_i\leq z_i,\ -x_i\leq z_i\}} \sum_i c_i^\top z_i \quad \text{or} \quad \min_{\{x|A(x^+-x^-)\geq b,\ x_i^+, x_i^-\geq 0\}} \sum_i c_i^\top (x_i^+ + x_i^-)$$

3 Simplex method

Optimal BFS does not imply that every optimal solution is a BFS, meaning properties of BFS are not necessarily properties of optimal solutions. Simplex produces optimal solutions at BFS.

Basic objects. Basis B: m independent columns. BFS: $x_B = A_B^{-1} b$, $x_N = 0$. Reduced costs, $\bar{c}^\top = c^\top - c_B^\top A_B^{-1} A$. Optimal basis B such that $A_B^{-1} b \geq 0$ and $\bar{c} \geq 0$.

Feasible direction A vector d is a feasible direction at $x \in P$ if $\exists\, \theta > 0$ with $x + \theta d \in P$. Feasibility requires

$$A(x + \theta d) = b \implies Ad = 0 \implies A_B d_B + A_N d_N = 0 \implies d_B = -A_B^{-1} A_N d_N.$$

So any feasible direction from a BFS is determined by a choice of d_N (typically $d_N \geq 0$ for moves that keep $x + \theta d \geq 0$).

Reduced costs & optimality. Define the reduced cost vector at BFS x with basis B, $\bar{c}^\top = c^\top - c_B^\top A_B^{-1} A$, so for $j \in N$, $\bar{c}_j = c_j - c_B^\top A_B^{-1} A_j$. Let y be any feasible point and set $d = y - x$. Then $Ad = 0$, so $d_B = -A_B^{-1} A_N d_N$. The change in objective is

$$c^\top (y - x) = c_B^\top d_B + c_N^\top d_N = c_B^\top (-A_B^{-1} A_N d_N) + c_N^\top d_N = (c_N^\top - c_B^\top A_B^{-1} A_N) d_N = \bar{c}_N^\top d_N.$$

At a BFS, $x_N = 0$, and for any feasible y we have $y_N \geq 0$, hence $d_N = y_N - x_N \geq 0$. If $\bar{c}_N \geq 0$, then $\bar{c}_N^\top d_N \geq 0$ for all feasible y, so $c^\top y \geq c^\top x$, and x is optimal. For optimal x and *infeasible* basic solution, y ($Ay = b, y \not\geq 0$), with nonnegative reduced costs, $\bar{c}^{(y)}$, we have $c^\top y \leq c^\top x$: $c^\top (y - x) = c^\top (y - x) - c_B^\top B^{-1} A (y - x) = \bar{c}^{(y)\top} y - \bar{c}^{(y)\top} x \geq -\bar{c}^{(y)\top} x$ (since $\bar{c}^{(y)} \geq 0$), $-\bar{c}^{(y)\top} x \leq 0$ (since $\bar{c}^{(y)} \geq 0$ and $x \geq 0$).

Simplex buildup. For entering index $j \in N$:

$$d_j = 1, \qquad d_k = 0 \ (k \in N \setminus \{j\}), \qquad d_B = -A_B^{-1} A_j \qquad \text{(since } Ad = 0 \Rightarrow A_B d_B + A_j = 0\text{)}$$

Feasible step size θ We seek the largest $\theta \geq 0$ with $x + \theta d \geq 0$. If $d \geq 0$ then $x + \theta d \geq 0$ for every $\theta \geq 0$ and if $\bar{c}_j < 0$ the objective decreases without bound (unbounded LP). If some $d_i < 0$, feasibility requires $x_i + \theta d_i \geq 0 \Rightarrow \theta \leq -x_i / d_i$. Thus $\theta^* = \min_{i \in B : d_i < 0} \{-x_i / d_i\}$ and the leaving index is the i attaining this minimum. The new BFS is

$$y_j = \theta^*, \qquad y_B = x_B + \theta^* d_B, \qquad y_i = 0 \ (i \in N \setminus \{j\})$$

Whenever $\theta^* > 0$, simplex moves feasible solution and reduces costs ($\theta^* \bar{c}_j < 0$)

Basis update and independence. The updated basis $\bar{B} = (B \setminus \{\ell\}) \cup \{j\}$ is linearly independent. If it were dependent, $\exists\, \lambda \neq 0$ with $A_{\bar{B}} \lambda = 0$. Multiplying by A_B^{-1} yields $A_B^{-1} A_{\bar{B}} \lambda = 0$. But

$$A_B^{-1} A_{\bar{B}} = [e_1, \ldots, e_{\ell-1},\ -A_B^{-1} A_j,\ e_{\ell+1}, \ldots, e_m],$$

By construction, the ℓth entry is $-d_{B_\ell} \neq 0$ and all other columns are 0 in the ℓth entry, thus $A_B^{-1} A_j$ is linearly independent from $A_B^{-1} A_{B \setminus \{\ell\}}$, so $\bar{B}$ is independent and y is a BFS.

Simplex iteration (1) Start with BFS x and associated basis B. (2) Compute reduced costs $\bar{c}$. If $\bar{c} \geq 0$: x optimal. Else choose entering j with $\bar{c}_j < 0$. (3) Compute $d_B = -A_B^{-1} A_j$. If $d_B \geq 0$: unbounded LP. (4) Compute $\theta^* = \min_{i \in B : d_i < 0} -x_i / d_i$ and leaving index ℓ. (5) Replace B_ℓ with j and compute new BFS y.

Termination (nondegenerate case). If $\theta^* > 0$ each pivot strictly decreases the objective, $c^\top y = c^\top x + \theta^*\, \bar{c}_j < c^\top x$. Since finitely many BFS exist and none repeat, simplex terminates.

Initialization (Phase I). To find an initial BFS, solve $\min_{\{x, y \mid Ax + y = b, x \geq 0, y \geq 0\}} \mathbf{1}^\top y$. A starting BFS is $(x, y) = (0, b)$. **(Infeasibility)** If the optimum satisfies $\mathbf{1}^\top y > 0$, the original LP is infeasible since this shows $\nexists x \geq 0 : Ax = b$. **(Degeneracy)** If optimal basis has $y = 0$, drop artificial columns and pivot to obtain a pure-x basis. **(Big M)** The Big-M method instead solves $\min\ c^\top x + M \mathbf{1}^\top y$ for sufficiently large M.

Anticycling. (Lexicographic rule) normalize rows by pivot element; pivot on lexicographically smallest row. Ensures: (i) all rows remain lex-positive, (ii) objective row increases lexicographically, (iii) termination. **(Bland's rule)** choose entering $\min_{\{j : \bar{c}_j < 0\}} j$ and leaving $\min_{\{i : d_i < 0\}} i$. Prevents cycling.

Revised simplex. Naive simplex recomputes A_B^{-1} each iteration ($O(m^3)$). Revised simplex updates inverses via $[A_B^{-1} \mid A_B^{-1} A_j] \xrightarrow{\text{row ops}} [\bar{A}_B^{-1} \mid e_\ell]$ yielding $O(m^2)$ per iteration.

Upper bound constraints. B is still the basis of the BFS, but N must be partitioned into $N \supseteq L = \{i : x_i = 0\}$ and $N \supseteq U = \{j : x_j = u_j\}$. Now $\forall\ d_i > 0$, θ^* will increase x_i, possibly over upper bound, u_i. Therefore the optimal stepsize determines the exiting variable, which is the arg min of the following

$$\theta^* = \min \left[\min_{\{i \mid d_i < 0, i \in B\}} \left(-\frac{x_i}{d_i} \right),\quad \min_{\{i \mid d_i > 0, i \in B\}} \left(\frac{u_i - x_i}{d_i} \right) \right]$$

Candidate entering variables are $j \in N : (\bar{c}_j < 0, x_j = 0) \cup (\bar{c}_j > 0, x_j = u_j)$.

Tableau implementation efficiency comes from maintaining and updating $A_B^{-1}[b \mid A]$. The tableau structure is

$$\left[\begin{array}{c|c} -c_B^\top A_B^{-1} b & c^\top - c_B^\top A_B^{-1} A \\ \hline A_B^{-1} b & A_B^{-1} A \end{array}\right] = \left[\begin{array}{c|ccc} -c^\top x & \bar{c}_1 & \dots & \bar{c}_n \\ \hline x_B & -d^{(1)} & \dots & -d^{(n)} \end{array}\right]$$

Left column: objective value $-c^\top x$ and current basic solution x_B. Right block: reduced costs $\bar{c}$ search directions $-d^{(j)} = A_B^{-1} A_j$

Step	Iteration 1	Iteration 2
1. Choose pivot column: select ℓ with $\bar{c}_\ell < 0$	$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & -2 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 6 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 8 & 2 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 6 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$
2. Ratio test: among rows, choose $i = \arg\min_{\{d_i^{(\ell)} < 0\}} \left(-x_i / d_i^{(\ell)}\right)$	$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & -2 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 6 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 8 & 2 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 6 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$
3. Apply row operations to get $-d_i^{(\ell)} = 1$ and $d_{k \neq i}^{(\ell)} = 0$	$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & -2 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 8 & 2 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 6 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 4 & 1 & 0 & 1/2 & 1/2 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & -1/2 & 1/2 \end{bmatrix}$
4. Apply row operations to set $\bar{c}_l = 0$	$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 8 & 2 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 6 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} 10 & 0 & 0 & 1/2 & 3/2 \\ 4 & 1 & 0 & 1/2 & 1/2 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & -1/2 & 1/2 \end{bmatrix}$

Tableau optimality condition exercises.

$$\left[\begin{array}{c|cccc} -2 & 0 & \alpha \geq 1 & \delta \in [-1,0) & 0 \\ \hline 1 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 1 \\ \gamma & 1 & -2 & 2 & 0 \end{array}\right] \Longrightarrow \left[\begin{array}{c|cccc} -2 - \gamma\delta/2 & -\delta/2 & \alpha + \delta & 0 & 0 \\ \hline 1 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 1 \\ \gamma/2 & 1/2 & -1 & 1 & 0 \end{array}\right] \Longrightarrow \begin{cases} \gamma > 0 & \text{achieve optimal after pivot; original obj was suboptimal} \\ \gamma = 0 & \text{degenerate pivot; original obj was already optimal} \end{cases}$$

$$\left[\begin{array}{c|cccc} * & 0 & 0 & 4 & \gamma \\ \hline 2 & 1 & 0 & -3 & -5 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & \alpha \end{array}\right] \Longrightarrow \left[\begin{array}{c|cccc} * & 0 & -\gamma/\alpha & 4 & 0 \\ \hline 2 & 1 & 0 & -3 & -5 \\ 0 & 0 & 1/\alpha & 0 & 1 \end{array}\right] \Longrightarrow \begin{cases} \gamma \geq 0 & \text{optimal} \\ \gamma < 0, \alpha > 0 & \text{optimal} \end{cases}$$

4 Duality

Intuition

- Standard form problem ($\min_{\{x \mid Ax = b, x \geq 0\}} c^\top x$): If p satisfies $p^\top A \leq c^\top \Longrightarrow p^\top b = p^\top Ax \leq c^\top x \; \forall$ feasible x.
- General form problem ($\min_{\{x \mid Ax \geq b\}} c^\top x$): If $p \geq 0$ satisfies $p^\top A = c^\top \Longrightarrow p^\top b \leq p^\top Ax = c^\top x \; \forall$ feasible x
- A_B^{-1} uniquely determines $x, p : (x_B, p) = (A_B^{-1} b, c_B^\top A_B^{-1})$: $p^\top b = (c_B^\top A_B^{-1}) b = c_B^\top (A_B^{-1} b) = c_B^\top x_B = c^\top x$

Lagrangian derivation (standard form).

$$\mathbf{L}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{p}) = c^\top x + p^\top (b - Ax) = p^\top b + (c^\top - p^\top A)x \qquad \mathbf{g}(\mathbf{p}) = \min_{x \geq 0} L(x, p) = \begin{cases} p^\top b, & c^\top - p^\top A \geq 0, \\ -\infty, & \text{else} \end{cases} \qquad \max \; \mathbf{g}(\mathbf{p}) = \max_{\{p \mid p^\top A \leq c^\top\}} p^\top b$$

(x^*, p^*) is primal-dual optimal $\iff$ it is a **saddle point**: $L(x^*, p) \leq L(x^*, p^*) \leq L(x, p^*) \quad \forall x \geq 0, \; p.$

Sign rules (minimization).

- **Constraint signs** come from enforcing $L(x, p) \leq c^\top x$ for feasible x. For a constraint of the form $Ax \geq b$, feasibility means $b - Ax \leq 0$. Using the Lagrangian term $p^\top (b - Ax)$ with $p \geq 0$ to ensure $L(x, p) = c^\top x + p^\top (b - Ax) \leq c^\top x$, so $g(p) = \inf_x L(x, p)$ is a *lower bound* on the primal optimum.
- **Variable signs** come from making $\inf_x L(x, p)$ finite. If $x \geq 0$, we require $(c^\top - p^\top A) \geq 0$; otherwise the Lagrangian can be pushed to $-\infty$ by sending $x \to +\infty$. If x is free, the only way to avoid $-\infty$ in both directions is $c^\top - p^\top A = 0^\top$

Common primal-dual pairs

$$\min \; c^\top x : \{x \mid Ax = b, \; x \geq 0\} \iff \max \; p^\top b : \{p \mid p^\top A \leq c\} \qquad \min \; c^\top x : \{x \mid Ax \geq b\} \iff \max \; p^\top b : \{p \mid p \geq 0, \; p^\top A = c\}$$

$$\min \; c^\top x : \{x \mid Ax \geq b, \; x \geq 0\} \iff \max \; p^\top b : \{p \mid p \geq 0, \; p^\top A \leq c\} \qquad \max \; c^\top x : \{x \mid Ax \leq b, \; x \geq 0\} \iff \min \; p^\top b : \{p \mid p \geq 0, \; p^\top A \geq c^\top\}$$

$$\min \; c^\top x : \{x \mid A_1 x \geq b_1, \; A_2 x = b_2, \; x \geq 0\} \iff \max \; p_1^\top b_1 + p_2^\top b_2 : \{p_1, \; p_2 \mid p_1 \geq 0, \; p_1^\top A_1 + p_2^\top A_2 \leq c\}$$

$$\min \; c^\top x + d^\top y : \{x, y \mid Ax + By \geq e, \; Cx + Dy = f, \; x \geq 0\} \iff \max \; p^\top e + q^\top f : \{p, q \mid p \geq 0, \; p^\top A + q^\top C \leq c^\top, \; p^\top B + q^\top D = d\}$$

4.1 Weak and strong duality, complementary slackness

Weak duality If x is primal feasible and p is dual feasible, then $p^\top b \le c^\top x$. **(Proof)** Suppose x, p primal, dual feasible and let $u_i = p_i(a_i^\top x - b_i),\ v_j = (c_j - p^\top A_j)x_j$. By construction, $\text{sign}(a_i^\top x - b) = \text{sign}(p_i)$ and $\text{sign}(c_j - p^\top A_j) = \text{sign}(x_j)$ So $u_i, v_j \ge 0\ \forall i, j$. Now

$$c^\top x - p^\top b = p^\top Ax - p^\top b + c^\top x - p^\top Ax = p^\top(Ax - b) + (c^\top - p^\top A)x = \sum_i u_i + \sum_j v_j \ge 0$$

4.1.1 Strong duality

If $(P), (D)$ have optimal solutions, then $c^\top x = p^\top b$.

Simplex proof (standard form). Let x^* be an optimal BFS with basis B. Then $\bar{c}^\top = c^\top - c_B^\top A_B^{-1} A \ge 0$. Define $p^{*\top} = c_B^\top A_B^{-1}$. Then

$$p^{*\top} A = c_B^\top A_B^{-1} A \le c^\top, \quad p^{*\top} b = c_B^\top A_B^{-1} b = c_B^\top x_B^* = c^\top x^* \qquad \text{(So } p^* \text{ dual feasible and optimal, with equal cost)}$$

Proof using Farkas' lemma Consider primal-dual pair, $(P) : \min_{\{x | Ax \ge b\}} c^\top x,\ (D) : \min_{\{p | p \ge 0, p^\top A = c^\top\}} p^\top b$, let x^* be an optimal BFS, and define $I = \{i \mid a_i^\top x^* = b_i\}$. Choose d such that $A_I d \ge 0 \implies A_I(x^* + \epsilon d) \ge A_I x^* = b_I$. For $j \notin I$ and ϵ sufficiently small, $a_j^\top(x^* + \epsilon d) > b_i \implies x^* + \epsilon d$ feasible solution. By optimality of $x^* \implies c^\top d \ge 0$. By Farkas' lemma, $\exists\ p_I \ge 0$ such that $p_I^\top A_I = c$. Extend p to all indices by setting $p_j = 0$ for $j \notin I$. Then $p \ge 0,\ p^\top A = p_I^\top A_I = c^\top$, so p is dual feasible. Since $p^\top b = p_I^\top b_I = p_I^\top A_I x^* = c^\top x^*,\ p$ is dual feasible and attains the same value as the primal optimum.

4.1.2 Complementary slackness

x, p are primal-dual optimal solutions $\iff\ p \odot (Ax - b) = 0,\ (c - p^\top A) \odot x = 0$. Recall in the proof of Weak duality we defined u_i, v_j and showed $u_i \ge 0,\ v_j \ge 0,\ c^\top x - p^\top b = \sum_i u_i + \sum_j v_j$. **(Proof $\Rightarrow$)** By **Strong duality**, $c^\top x = p^\top b \implies \sum_i u_i + \sum_j v_j = 0 \implies u_i = v_j = 0\ \forall\ i, j$. **(Proof $\Leftarrow$)** if $u_i = v_j = 0\ \forall\ i, j \implies c^\top x - p^\top b = 0 \implies c^\top x = p^\top b$.

Use as optimality test To test candidate x for optimality in (P): (1) Check primal feasibility, (2) Form dual and identify $I = \{i \mid a_i^\top x = b_i\}$, (3) Solve for $p^\top A_I = c_I^\top$, (4) If p satisfies dual feasibility, x is optimal.

Demonstrating x is a BFS. Given $x \in P = \{x \mid Ax = b,\ x \ge 0\},\ \exists\ p : (c^\top - p^\top A) \odot x = 0$ and assume (i) every BFS is nondegenerate and (ii) at BFS, nonbasic reduced costs are nonzero.

$$\text{for some } \lambda \in \mathbb{R}^K_{\ge 0}, \lambda^\top e = 1: \quad \left(c^\top - p^\top A\right) \odot x = \mathbf{0} \iff (c^\top - p^\top A) \odot \sum_{k=1}^K \lambda_k x^{(k)} = \mathbf{0}$$

$$\text{for } x^{(k)} : \lambda_k > 0: \quad \left(c_{B^{(k)}}^\top - p^\top A_{B^{(k)}}\right) \odot x_{B^{(k)}} = \mathbf{0} \implies p^\top A_{B^{(k)}} = c_{B^{(k)}}^\top \implies p^\top = c_{B^{(k)}}^\top A_{B^{(k)}}^{-1}$$

$$: \quad \bar{c}_{N^{(k)}} = c_{N^{(k)}}^\top - c_{B^{(k)}}^\top A_{B^{(k)}}^{-1} A_{N^{(k)}} \ne \mathbf{0} \implies x_{N^{(k)}} = 0 \implies x_{B^{(k)}} = A_{B^{(k)}}^{-1} b \implies x = x^{(k)}$$

4.1.3 Strict complementary slackness

Given Primal-Dual pair $(P) : \min_{\{x | Ax = b, x \ge 0\}} c^\top x,\ (D) : \max_{\{p | p^\top A \le c\}} p^\top b$, both with optimal solutions, $\exists$ optimal $x \ge 0, p$ such that $\forall j$ either $x_j > 0$ or $p^\top A_j < c_j$. **(Proof sketch)** (i) first prove that for problem where $x_j = 0$ in all optimal solutions: Set up new primal-dual problems $(P') : \min_{\{x | Ax = b, x \ge 0\}} c^\top x - \delta e_j^\top x,\ (D') : \max_{\{p | p^\top A \le c - \delta e_j\}} p^\top b$. Consider reduced cost vector $\bar{c}^\top = (c - \delta e_j) - c_B B^{-1} A \implies \delta \le c_j - c_B B^{-1} A_j$. Reason that for sufficiently small δ, same x^* is optimal for (P') and note new constraint of dual implies $p^\top A_j < c_j$. (ii) Then consider the sets of optimal solutions and corresponding sets of indices:

$$\mathcal{X} = \{x \mid Ax = b, x \ge 0, c^\top x = val(P)\} \qquad \mathcal{P} = \{p \mid p^\top A \le c, p^\top b = val(D)\}$$

$$S = \{j \mid \exists x \in \mathcal{X}, x_j > 0\} \qquad S^C = \{j \mid x_j = 0\ \forall x \in \mathcal{X}\}$$

Let $x^{(k)} \in \mathcal{X}$ with $x_k^{(k)} > 0$. Define $\bar{x} = \frac{1}{|S|}\sum_{k \in S} x^{(k)}$, $\bar{p} = \frac{1}{|S^C|}\sum_{k \in S^C} p^{(k)}$, and demonstrate feasiblity and optimality. Now since sets S, S^C partition the index set, we have $\forall j \in [n]$ either $x_j > 0$ or $p^\top A_j < c_j$

4.1.4 Primal-dual outcome possibilities

$(P)/(D)$ unbounded $\Rightarrow$ $(D)/(P)$ infeasible. **(Proof)** (P) unbounded $\Rightarrow c^\top x = -\infty \Rightarrow p^\top b \le -\infty$ by weak duality, which is impossible. (P) finite optimum $\iff$ (D) finite optimum by strong duality. $(P)/(D)$ infeasible $\Rightarrow$ $(D)/(P)$ infeasible *or* unbounded.

Primal-dual boundedness. LP $\min_{\{x|Ax\le b\}} c^\top x$ bounded $\iff$ c is a nonnegative linear combination of the rows of A. **(Proof)** Using duality, we see $(D) : \max_{\{p|p\ge 0,\ p^\top A=c\}} p^\top b$ has a feasible set that is precisely this statement. So feasible optimal dual problem $\iff$ bounded optimal primal problem.

Dual simplex Helpful to consider in the Tableau structure. Always keep Dual constraints, $\bar{c} = c^\top - p^\top A \ge 0$, and pivot until primal constraints are feasible ($A_B^{-1}b \ge 0$).

$$\left[\begin{array}{c|c} -p^\top b & c^\top - p^\top A \\ \hline A_B^{-1}b & A_B^{-1}A \end{array}\right] = \left[\begin{array}{c|c} -c_B^\top A_B^{-1}b & c^\top - c_B^\top A_B^{-1}A \\ \hline A_B^{-1}b & A_B^{-1}A \end{array}\right] = \left[\begin{array}{c|c} -c^\top x & \bar{c}^\top \\ \hline A_B^{-1}b & A_B^{-1}A \end{array}\right]$$

(1) Start with basic solution x and corresponding basis B with $\bar{c} \ge 0$, (2) choose a row ℓ with $v^{(\ell)\top} = (A_B^{-1}b)_\ell < 0$ (if none, terminate with optimal), (3) choose column j with $v_j^{(\ell)} < 0$, (4) use ratio $\gamma^* = \min_{j:v_j^{(\ell)}<0} \frac{\bar{c}_j}{-v_j^{(\ell)}}$ to select the entering variable (A_j). If $v^{(\ell)} \ge 0$ terminate as unbounded.

4.2 Degeneracy

BFS $x \in P$ is **degenerate** if $> n$ constraints are active at x. Degeneracy is representation-invariant for standard-form LPs (changing bases does not change which BFSs degenerate); *not* generally true in non-standard form.

- **Intuition: Multiple basis for BFS.** If a basic variable is zero, its index can be swapped with a nonbasic zero variable, producing different bases for the same BFS. Optimality depends on reduced costs, which depend on the basis. Thus, for a degenerate optimal BFS, changing the basis may change reduced costs while leaving the point unchanged, so some corresponding bases need not be optimal.
- **Dual nondegeneracy $\implies$ unique optimum.** See proof in LP geometry section. The converse is not true: Counterexample (primal nondegeneracy and no unique dual optimum; requires redundant constraint): $(P) : \min_{\{x_1=1,\ x_2=1,\ x_1=1,\ x\ge 0\}} 0,\ (D) : \max_{\{p_1+p_3\le 0,\ p_2\le 0\}} p_1 + p_2$.
- **Algorithmic consequences.** Degeneracy may cause *stalling* (a pivot yields a new basis but the same BFS) and *cycling* (return to a previously visited basis)
- **Characterizations.** Standard form (BFS has m basic variables): x degenerate $\iff$ $\exists$ basic variable $x_i = 0$ $\iff$ $|\text{supp}(x)| < m$ $\iff$ same BFS can be obtained from multiple bases. Inequality form: x degenerate $\iff$ $|I(x) = \{i \mid a_i^\top x = b_i\}| > n$ $\iff$ A_I linearly dependent rows.
- **Support size does not imply BFS.** Even if $|\text{supp}(x)| = m$, x need not be a BFS. Example: $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, $b = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$, $x^\top = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$. x feasible and $|\text{supp}(x)| = 2 = m$, but $\text{rank}\left(A_{\text{supp}(x)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}\right) = 1$

Primal vs dual degeneracy. For basis B and standard form polyhedron:

- Degeneracy (primal or dual) means *multiple bases* can represent the same BFS. It does *not* imply multiple optimal primal or dual solutions.
- Dual basic solution (associated with B): $p^\top = c_B^\top A_B^{-1}$, $\bar{c}_N^\top = c_N^\top - p^\top A_N$. Dual BFS is *degenerate* iff some nonbasic variable has reduced cost $\bar{c}_{j\in N} = 0$. More than n inequalities of $p^\top A \le c$ are tight at the same p, so several bases give the same dual BFS p.
- Degenerate dual $\not\Rightarrow$ degenerate primal: (Counterexample)

$$(P) : \min_{\{x|x_1,x_2\ge 0, x_1+x_2=1\}} x_1 + x_2 \qquad (D) : \max_{\{p|p\le 1, p\le 1\}} p \iff \max_{\{(p,s_1,s_2)|p+s_1=1,\ p+s_2=1,\ s\ge 0\}} p$$

4.3 Farkas' lemma

Intuition. Farkas gives a certificate of infeasibility: either (i) $Ax = b,\ x \ge 0$ has a solution, or (ii) $\exists p : p^\top A \ge 0^\top,\ \ p^\top b < 0$ that proves no such solution can exist. Suppose true, then $\forall\ x \ge 0,\ p^\top Ax \ge 0$. But since $p^\top b < 0$ we have $p^\top Ax \ne p^\top b \implies Ax \ne b$.

Farkas' theorems of the alternative

- Exactly one holds: $(\exists x \geq 0 :\ Ax = b)$ or $(\exists p :\ p^\top A \geq 0^\top,\ p^\top b < 0)$
- Equivalently: $(\exists x :\ x \geq 0, Ax = b) \iff (\nexists p :\ p^\top A \geq 0^\top, p^\top b < 0)$
- Equivalently: $(\forall p : p^\top A \geq 0^\top,\ p^\top b \geq 0) \iff (\exists x \geq 0 :\ Ax = b)$
- Cone constraint: $(\exists x \neq 0 :\ Ax = 0, x \geq 0) \iff (\nexists p :\ p^\top A > 0)$
- General form inequality (include weak duality): $(\forall x\text{:}\ Ax \leq b,\ c^\top x \leq d) \iff (\exists p \geq 0 :\ p^\top A = c^\top,\ p^\top b \leq d)$

Proof using Duality **((a)⇒ ¬(b))** $\exists x : x \geq 0, Ax = b \Rightarrow p^\top b = p^\top Ax \Rightarrow$ so $\nexists p$ such that $p^\top b < 0$ and $p^\top b = p^\top Ax \geq 0$. **(¬(a)⇒(b))** Consider primal-dual pair, $(P) : \max_{\{x|x\geq 0, Ax=b\}} 0^\top x,\ (D) : \min_{\{p|p^\top A\geq 0\}} p^\top b$. Not (a) $\implies$ (P) infeasible $\implies$ (D) unbounded (since $p = 0$ feasible) $\implies \exists p$ feasible such that $p^\top b < 0$.

Proof using Separating hyperplanes **(¬(a)⇒(b))** Let $S = \{y \mid x \geq 0,\ Ax = y\} = \{Ax \mid x \geq 0\}$. By assumption, $b \notin S$. By Separating Hyperplane theorem, $\exists\ \mathbf{p} : \mathbf{p}^\top \mathbf{b} < \mathbf{p}^\top \mathbf{y}\ \forall\ y \in S$. Now $\forall\ \lambda > 0,\ \lambda A_i \in S \implies p^\top b < \lambda p^\top A_i \iff p^\top A > (1/\lambda) p^\top b \Rightarrow \lim_{\lambda\to\infty} p^\top A \geq 0 \implies \mathbf{p}^\top \mathbf{A} \geq \mathbf{0}$.

4.3.1 Farkas' lemma proof examples

- $(\{x \mid Ax \geq 0,\ x \geq 0\} \subseteq \{x \mid x_1 = 0\}) \iff (\exists p \geq 0$ such that $p^\top A \leq 0,\ p^\top A_1 < 0)$.
  Consider primal-dual pair, $(P) : \min_{\{x|x\geq 0,\ Ax\geq 0\}} -e_1^\top x,\ (D) : \max_{\{p|p^\top A\leq -e_1,\ p\geq 0\}} p^\top 0$. **(Proof ⇒)** $val((P)) = 0 \implies (D)$ feasible and there exists such a p. **(Proof ⇐)** $p^\top A_1 < 0 \Rightarrow p^\top A_1 \leq -1 \Rightarrow (D)$ feasible with $val((D) = 0) \implies e_1^\top x = 0 \implies x_1 = 0$ $\square$
- $(\exists x \neq 0$ such that $Ax = 0, x \geq 0) \iff (\nexists p$ such that $p^\top A > 0)$
  (Proof ⇒) Consider primal-dual pair, $(P) : \min_{\{x|x\geq 0,\ Ax=0\}} 0^\top x,\ (D) : \max_{\{p|p^\top A\leq 0\}} p^\top 0$. (P) feasible $\Rightarrow$ (D) feasible and $p^\top A \leq 0$. **(Proof ⇐)** Consider primal-dual pair, $(P) : \min_{\{p|A^\top p\geq e\}} 0^\top p,\ (D) : \max_{\{x|x\geq 0,\ Ax=0\}} e^\top x$ (note $p^\top A < 0 \Rightarrow p^\top A \leq e$ because we can scale). (P) feasible $\implies e^\top x = 0$ and $x \geq 0 \implies x = 0$ $\square$
- $(\exists x$ with $Ax < 0) \iff (S = \{u \mid u^\top A = 0, u \geq 0, \mathbf{1}^\top u = 1\} = \emptyset)$

  (Proof ⇐ using Farkas) $S = \{u \mid [A, \mathbf{1}]^\top u = [\mathbf{0}^\top, 1]^\top,\ u \geq 0\}$. By Farkas, $S = \emptyset \implies \exists\ p, q$ free such that $p^\top A^\top + q\mathbf{1}^\top \geq \mathbf{0}^\top$ and $p^\top \mathbf{0} + q < 0 \implies q < 0$ and $Ap > 0 \implies Ax < 0$ for $x = -p$.

  (Proof ⇐ using Strong duality) Consider primal-dual pair $(P) : \min_{\{u|[A,\mathbf{1}]^\top u=[\mathbf{0}^\top,1]^\top, u\geq 0\}} \mathbf{0}^\top u,\ (D) : \max_{\{(p,q)|Ap+\mathbf{1}q\leq 0,(p,q}$ (P) infeasible $\implies (D)$ unbounded (since $(0,0)$ feasible) $\implies q > 0 \implies Ap < 0$.

  (Proof ⇒ using Strong duality) Note $Ax < 0 \iff Ax \leq -\mathbf{1}$. Now consider primal-dual pair $(P) : \max_{\{x|Ax\leq -\mathbf{1}\}} \mathbf{0}^\top x,\ (D) : \min_{\{u|u\geq 0, u^\top A=0\}} -\mathbf{1}^\top u$. (P) feasible $\implies (D)$ feasible $\implies -\mathbf{1}^\top u = 0$ by strong duality $\implies S = \emptyset$ since requires $\mathbf{1}^\top u = 1$
- Standard form $x_j = 0\ \forall x^*$ optimal $\Rightarrow \exists p^*$ such that $p^{*\top} A_j < c_j$

  (Proof) Define new P-D pair: $(P')\ \min_{\{Ax=b, x\geq 0,\ -c^\top x\geq -f^*\}} -e_j^\top x,\ (D')\ \max_{\{q^\top A - rc^\top \leq -e_j^\top,\ q\geq 0\}} q^\top b - rf^*$. Two cases: (i) $r^* > 0$: We see that $\frac{q^*}{r^*}$ is optimal and feasible for (D) since $\frac{q^*}{r^*}^\top b = f^*,\ \frac{q^*}{r^*}^\top A \leq c^\top - \frac{e_j}{r^*}^\top$. Further, this implies $\frac{q^*}{r^*}^\top A_j < c_j$. (ii) $r^* = 0$: Then $q^{*\top} b = 0$. For p^* optimal for (D), we see $(p^* + q^*)^\top$ is also optimal and feasible for (D). Further, $(p^* + q^*)^\top A = p^{*\top} A + q^{*\top} A \leq c^\top - e_j$ so $(p^* + q^*)^\top A_j < c_j$ $\square$
- $(\exists\ x \geq 0,\ y : Ax + By \geq e,\ Cx + Dy = f) \iff (\nexists\ p \geq 0,\ q : p^\top B + q^\top D = 0,\ p^\top A + q^\top C \leq 0,\ p^\top e + q^\top f > 0)$
  (Proof ⇒) Contradiction: assume both are true and use all properties to arrive at $p^\top A + q^\top C \not\leq 0$

  $$p^\top(Ax + By) \geq p^\top e \implies p^\top(Ax + By) + q^\top(Cx + Dy) \geq p^\top e + q^\top f > 0 \implies (p^\top A + q^\top C)x > 0 \implies p^\top A + q^\top C \not\leq 0$$

  (Proof ⇐) Consider the primal-dual pair

  $$(P) : \min_{\{x,y|Ax+By\geq e,\ Cx+Dy=f,\ x\geq 0\}} x^\top 0 + y^\top 0 \qquad (D) : \max_{\{p,q|p\geq 0,\ p^\top A+q^\top C\leq 0,\ p^\top B+q^\top D=0\}} p^\top e + q^\top f$$

  (P) infeasible $\implies (D)$ unbounded ($(0,0)$ feasible solution) $\implies \exists$ feasible $(p, q) : p^\top e + q^\top f \geq 1 \implies p^\top e + q^\top f > 0$. $\implies p \geq 0,\ p^\top A + q^\top C \leq 0,\ p^\top B + q^\top D = 0$

4.4 Separating hyperplanes to duality

Weierstrass' theorem If $f : \mathbb{R}^n \mapsto \mathbb{R}$ continuous and $S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is nonempty, closed, and bounded, then $\exists x \in S$ such that $f(x) \leq f(y)\ \forall\ y \in S$. Similarly, $\exists z \in S$ such that $f(z) \geq f(y)\ \forall\ y \in S$.

Separating hyperplane theorem $S \in \mathbb{R}^n$ nonempty, closed, convex and $z \notin S$, $\exists c \in \mathbb{R}^n$ such that $c^\top z < c^\top x\ \forall\ x \in S$. **(Proof)** Fix $w \in S$, let $B = \{x \mid \|x - z\|_2 \leq \|w - z\|_2\}$. $D = S \cap B$ is nonempty since $w \in D$, and closed since S, B closed, bounded since B bounded. Consider $f(x) = \|x - z\|_2$ which is continuous. By Weistrass' theorem $\exists y \in D$ such that $\|y - z\|_2 \leq \|x - z\|_2\ \forall x \in D$. $\forall\ x \in S \setminus D \Rightarrow \|x - z\|_2 > \|w - z\|_2 \geq \|y - z\|_2$ so y minimizes $\|x - z\|_2\ \forall\ x \in S$ (so y is closest element of S to z). Let $x \in S$. S convex $\Rightarrow y + \lambda(x - y) \in S\ \forall\ \lambda \in (0, 1]$.

$$\begin{aligned}
\|y - z\|_2^2 \leq \|y + \lambda(x - y) - z\|_2^2 &= \|y - z\|_2^2 + 2\lambda(y - z)^\top(x - y) + \lambda^2 \|x - y\|_2^2 \\
&\overset{1/\lambda}{\Longrightarrow} 2(y - z)^\top(x - y) + \lambda \|x - y\|_2^2 \geq 0 \overset{\lim_{\lambda \to 0}}{\Longrightarrow} (y - z)^\top(x - y) \geq 0 \\
&\Longrightarrow (y - z)^\top x \geq (y - z)^\top y = (y - z)^\top z + (y - z)^\top(y - z) > (y - z)^\top z \Longrightarrow c^\top x > c^\top z \qquad (c = y - z)
\end{aligned}$$

4.5 Cones and extreme rays

Definitions **(Cone)** A set $C \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ is a cone if $x \in C,\ \lambda \geq 0 \Rightarrow \lambda x \in C$. Hence $0 \in C$. **(Polyhedral cone)** $\mathcal{C} = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ax \geq 0\}$. **(Recession cone)** For $P = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ax \geq b\}$ and any $y \in P$, $RC_P(y) = \{d \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid y + \lambda d \in P,\ \forall\ \lambda \geq 0\}$. Note $\forall\ y, z \in P,\ RC_P(y) = RC_P(z) = RC_P := \{d \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ad \geq 0\}$. For $Q = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ax = b,\ x \geq 0\},\ RC_Q = \{d \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ad = 0,\ d \geq 0\}$.

Equivalences For polyhedral cone $\mathcal{C} = \{x \mid Ax \geq 0\} \subset \mathbb{R}^n$, the following are equivalent: 0 is an extreme point of $\mathcal{C} \iff \mathcal{C}$ does not contain a line $\iff \exists\ n$ linearly independent rows of A. **(Intuition)** A cone contains a line $\iff$ there is a direction $d \neq 0$ with $Ad = 0$ and $-d \in C$; equivalently, equalities do not create a BFS at the origin.

4.5.1 Extreme rays

Definition (1) $x \neq 0 \in C \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ is an extreme ray if there are $n - 1$ linearly independent constraints active at x. (2) An extreme ray of RC_P with nonempty P is an extreme ray of P (note: $\exists$ finite number of extreme rays in P).

Finite optimal cost over cone. For $C = \{x \mid Ax \geq 0\}$, $\min_{\{x \in C\}} c^\top x = -\infty \iff \exists$ extreme ray $d \in C$ such that $c^\top d < 0$. **(Proof $\Leftarrow$)** Trivial: If $\exists d \in C$ such that $c^\top d < 0$ then $\lambda d \in C\ \forall\ \lambda \geq 0$. **(Proof $\Rightarrow$)** From given we assume $\exists x \in C$ such that $c^\top x = -1$. Define $P = \{x \mid Ax \geq 0, c^\top x = -1\} \subset C$. C pointed $\Rightarrow$ C does not contain a line $\Rightarrow P$ has at least 1 extreme point, call it d. d extreme $\Rightarrow n$ linearly active constraints, one of which must be $c^\top x = -1$. The remaining $n - 1$ are from $x \in C \Longrightarrow d$ extreme ray of C with $c^\top d < 0$ $\square$

Finite optimal cost over polyhedron. For $P = \{x \mid Ax \geq b\}$, $\min_{\{x \in P\}} c^\top x = -\infty \iff \exists$ extreme ray $d \in RC_P$ such that $c^\top d < 0$. **(Proof $\Leftarrow$)** Trivial: If $\exists d \in RC_P$ such that $c^\top d < 0$, then $x + \lambda d \in P,\ \forall\ x \in P,\ \forall\ \lambda \geq 0$. And $c^\top(x + \lambda d) = c^\top x + \lambda c^\top d \to -\infty$. As $\lambda \to \infty$. **(Proof $\Rightarrow$)** Consider primal-dual pair $(P) : \min_{\{x \in P\}} c^\top x$, $(D) : \max_{\{p \in Q = \{p \mid p \geq 0, p^\top A = c\}\}} p^\top b$. (P) unbounded $\Longrightarrow$ (D) infeasible $\Longrightarrow$ $(D') : \max_{\{p \in Q\}} p^\top \mathbf{0}$ infeasible. Dual of (D'), $(P') = \min_{\{x \in \tilde{P} = \{x \mid Ax \geq 0\}\}} c^\top x$ is unbounded (since $x = 0$ feasible) $\Longrightarrow \exists$ extreme ray $d \in \tilde{P}$ such that $c^\top d < 0$ (by previous theorem). $\tilde{P} = RC_P \Longrightarrow$ extreme ray of RC_P is extreme ray of P $\square$

4.5.2 Resolution theorem

For $P = \{x \mid Ax \geq b\}$ nonempty with at least one extreme point, let $\{x^{(k)}\}_{k \in \mathcal{K}_P}$ be all its extreme points and $\{w^{(r)}\}_{r \in \mathcal{R}_P}$ be all its extreme rays. Then $P = Q = \left\{\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_P} \lambda_k x^{(k)} + \sum_{r \in \mathcal{R}_P} \theta_r w^{(r)} \mid \lambda_k \geq 0, \theta_r \geq 0, \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_P} \lambda_k = 1\right\}$. **(Proof $Q \subset P$)** $z \in Q \Rightarrow Az = \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_P} \lambda_k \underbrace{Ax^{(k)}}_{\geq b} + \sum_{r \in \mathcal{R}_P} \theta_r \underbrace{Aw^{(r)}}_{\geq 0} \geq \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_P} \lambda_k b + 0 = b \Rightarrow z \in P$. **(Proof $P \subset Q$)** Contradiction: Suppose $\exists z \in P,\ z \notin Q$. Consider primal-dual pair $(P) : \max_{\{(\lambda, \theta) \mid z = X\lambda + W\theta,\ \mathbf{1}^\top \lambda = 1,\ \lambda,\ \theta \geq 0\}} \mathbf{0}$; $(D) : \min_{\{(p,q) \mid p^\top X + q\mathbf{1}^\top \geq 0, p^\top W \geq 0\}} p^\top z + q$. By assumption $(z \notin Q)$, (P) infeasible $\Longrightarrow$ (D) unbounded (since $(p, q) = (0, 0)$ is feasible) $\Longrightarrow \exists (p, q)$ such that $p^\top z + q < 0$ and $p^\top X \geq -q\mathbf{1}^\top$, $p^\top W \geq 0^\top \Longrightarrow p^\top z < p^\top x^{(k)},\ \forall\ k \in \mathcal{K}_P$. Now consider new problem $(P') : \min_{\{Ax \geq b\}} p^\top x$ which has maximum at $x^{(k^*)}$ for some $k^* \in \mathcal{K}_P$. Since $z \in P$ is feasible this means $p^\top z \geq p^\top x^{(k^*)}$, arriving at our contradiction to $p^\top z < p^\top x^{(k)},\ \forall\ k \in \mathcal{K}_P$ $\square$

5 Sensitivity analysis

Given starting optimal basis, B, and associated optimal solution, x^*, we have $B^{-1}b \geq 0$ (feasibility) and $\overline{c} = c - c_B^\top B^{-1}A \geq 0$ (optimality). This section examines how these change with changes to (A, b, c) and how to efficiently solve for this deviation.

New variable. $\min_{\{x|x\geq 0, Ax+A_{n+1}x_{n+1}=b\}} c^\top x + c_{n+1}x_{n+1}$. Note that $(x, x_{n+1}) = (x^*, 0)$ is a BFS to this new problem under original B. Suffice to check optimality of $\overline{c}_{n+1} = c_{n+1} - c_B^\top B^{-1}A_{n+1} \geq 0$. To solve: augment the simplex tableau with an additional column, A_{n+1} and continue iterations.

New inequality. Introduce constraint $a_{m+1}^\top x \geq b_{m+1}$. If x^* satisfies this constraint, the augmented problem is optimal. Else, bring into standard form with new variable, $x_n + 1$ by defining

$$\overline{A} = \begin{bmatrix} A & 0 \\ a_{m+1}^\top & -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \overline{B} = \begin{bmatrix} B & 0 \\ a_{m+1_B}^\top & -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \overline{B}^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} B^{-1} & 0 \\ -a_{m+1_B}^\top B^{-1} & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

To solve: observe that this problem is dual-feasible (infeasible x, but nonnegative reduced cost vector), so use the dual simplex beginning at current BFS.

Change in b. Suppose $b' \leftarrow b + \delta e_i$. Optimality condition ($\overline{c} \geq 0$) unaffected, only feasibility ($x'_B = B^{-1}b' \geq 0$) must be considered. We have $B^{-1}(b + \delta e_i) = x_B + \delta B_i^{-1}$. For any δ in

$$\max_{\{j|[B^{-1}]_{ji}>0\}} \left(-\frac{x_{B(j)}}{[B^{-1}]_{ji}}\right) \leq \delta \leq \max_{\{j|[B^{-1}]_{ji}<0\}} \left(-\frac{x_{B(j)}}{[B^{-1}]_{ji}}\right)$$

optimality and primal feasiblity are satisfied. For δ outside this range, optimality (dual feasibility) is still satisfied, but not primal feasibility. Use dual simplex to find new solution.

Change in c. Suppose $c' \leftarrow c + \delta e_j$. Feasibility condition ($x_B = B^{-1}b \geq 0$) unaffected, only optimality ($\overline{c}' = c' - c_B'^\top B^{-1}A \geq 0$) must be considered. If j nonbasic, suffice to check $c_B^\top B^{-1}A_j \leq c_j + \delta \iff \overline{c}_j \geq -\delta$. If $j = \ell \in B$, $\overline{c}'^\top = (c + \delta e_j)^\top - (c_B + \delta e_\ell)^\top B^{-1}A$ and

$$\overline{c}'_i = \begin{cases} \overline{c}_i = 0 & i \in B \setminus \ell \\ \overline{c}_i + \delta - \delta = \overline{c}_i = 0 & i = \ell \in B \\ \overline{c}_i - \delta e_\ell^\top B^{-1}A_i & i \in N \end{cases}$$

Suffice to check $\overline{c}'^\top_N = \overline{c}_N^\top - \delta e_\ell^\top B^{-1}A_N \geq 0 \Longrightarrow \overline{c}_N \geq \delta e_\ell^\top B^{-1}A_N$. In both cases, if true, current solution is still optimal, else apply primal simplex starting at the current BFS.

Change in nonbasic column of A. Suppose $a'_{ij} \leftarrow a_{ij} + \delta$. If A_j nonbasic, then B is unaffected and hence primal feasiblity is unaffected. Only reduced cost of column j is affected. Condition to check is $c_j - c_B^\top B^{-1}(A_j + \delta e_i) \geq 0 \iff \overline{c}_j - \delta p_i \geq 0$. If this condition is violated, bring nonbasic column A_j into the basis and contine with the primal simplex method.

Change in basic column of A. Suppose $a'_{ij} \leftarrow a_{ij} + \delta$ and A_j basic with $j = B(\ell)$. Then $B' \leftarrow B + \delta e_i e_\ell^\top$. Must reason about feasibility ($x'_B = (B + \delta e_i e_\ell^\top)^{-1}b$) and optimality ($\overline{c}'^\top = [\overline{c}_B'^\top, \overline{c}_N'^\top] = [0, c_N^\top - c_B(B + \delta e_i e_\ell^\top)^{-1}N$). Must reason about inverse (use Sherman-Morrison formula) to bound δ.

Global sensitivity $G(c) = \min_{\{Ax=b, x\geq 0\}} c^\top x = \min_{\{i\in[N]\}} c^\top x^{(i)}$, a convex piecewise linear function of c. Use the primal problem to study this since changing c affects optimality and not feasibility. $F(b) = \min_{\{Ax=b, x\geq 0\}} c^\top x = \max_{\{j\in[M]\}} p^{(j)\top} b$, a convex piecewise linear function of b. Use dual problem to study since changing b affects dual optimality and not dual feasibility.

6 Large scale optimization

The general flow in this section is: Start with a restricted master (few columns or few cuts), solve, use a subproblem to check optimality (and generate violated constraints if not). Iteratively expand restricted master with constraint or variable.

Delayed column (row) generation

$$\min\ c^\top x \text{ s.t. } Ax = b,\ x \geq 0 \implies \min\ c_I^\top x_I \text{ s.t. } A_I x_I = b,\ x_I \geq 0 \implies \min_{j \notin I}\ \bar{c}_j = c_j - p^\top A_j \qquad \text{(column generation)}$$

$$\min\ z \text{ s.t. } z \odot e \geq Ax - b \implies \min\ z \text{ s.t. } z \odot e \geq A_I x - b_I \implies \max_{j \notin I}\ a_j^\top x - b_j \qquad \text{(row generation)}$$

Column generation either confirms we're optimal ($\min_{j \notin I} \bar{c}_j \geq 0$) or provides new *variable* j. Row generation either confirms we're feasible ($z \geq \max_{j \notin I} \{a_j^\top x - b_j\}$) or provides new *constraint* j.

6.1 Dantzig-Wolfe decomposition.

$$\min_{x_1, x_2}\ c_1^\top x_1 + c_2^\top x_2 \quad \text{s.t. } D_1 x_1 + D_2 x_2 = b_0,\ x_1 \in P_1,\ x_2 \in P_2, \quad P_i = \{x_i \geq 0 \mid F_i x_i = b_i\}$$

(Too many variables, partition feasible sets into blocks, P_i)

Master problem. Reformulate original problem using resolution theorem:

$$\min_{\lambda, \theta} \sum_{i \in \{1,2\}} \left(\sum_{j \in \mathcal{J}_i} \lambda_i^j c_i^\top x_i^j + \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i} \theta_i^k c_i^\top w_i^k \right) \quad \text{s.t. } \sum_{i \in \{1,2\}} \left(\sum_{j \in \mathcal{J}_i} \lambda_i^j D_i x_i^j + \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i} \theta_i^k D_i w_i^k \right) = b_0,\ \mathbf{1}^\top \lambda_i = 1,\ \lambda_i^j, \theta_i^k \geq 0,\ \forall i, j, k$$

Restricted master. Solve using only a subset of $\{x_i^j, w_i^k\}$. Let duals be q^k for $D_1 x_1 + D_2 x_2 = b_0$ and r_i^k for $\mathbf{1}^\top \lambda_i = 1$.

Subproblem. Form $\min_{\{x_i \mid x_i \in P_i\}} (c_i^\top - q^{k\top} D_i) x_i - r_i^k$: **(i) Unbounded**: $\exists\, w_i^k$ with $\bar{c} = (c_i^\top - q^\top D_i) w_i^k < 0 \Rightarrow$ add variable θ_i^k and parameters ($c_i^\top w_i^k$, $D_i w_i^k$). **(ii) Finite and** $< r_i^k$: $\exists\, x_i^j$ with $\bar{c} = (c_i^\top - q^\top D_i) x_i^j - r_i < 0 \Rightarrow$ add variable λ_i^j and parameters ($c_i^\top x_i^j$, $D_i x_i^j$).**(iii) Finite and** $\geq r_i^k$ **for all** i: $\bar{c} \geq 0 \Rightarrow$ optimal

Iteration bound The dual function is a lower bound on our master problem. At iteration k, we have dual-feasible values q^k and $\min_{x_i \in P_i} (c_i^\top - q^{k\top} D_i) x_i$. Together these can be used to construct a lower bound:

$$\min_{\lambda, \theta}\ L(\lambda, \theta, q \geq 0, r) = \min_{\lambda, \theta} \left\{ c^\top (X\lambda + W\theta) + q^\top (b_0 - D(X\lambda + W\theta)) + \sum_{i=1}^{2} r_i (1 - e^\top \lambda_i) \right\} \qquad \text{(Lagrangian)}$$

$$g(q \geq 0, r) = q^\top b_0 + \sum_{i=1}^{2} \left(r_i + \min \left\{ \min_{\lambda_i} (c_i^\top X_i - q^\top D_i X_i - r_i e^\top) \lambda_i,\ \min_{\theta_i} (c_i^\top W_i - q^\top D_i W_i) \theta_i \right\} \right)$$

(Dual problem)

$$= q^\top b_0 + \sum_{i=1}^{2} \left(\min \left\{ \min_{x_i^j} (c_i^\top x_i^j - q^\top D_i x_i^j),\ \min_{w_i^k} (c_i^\top w_i^k - q^\top D_i w_i^k) \theta \right\} \right) = q^\top b_0 + \sum_{i=1}^{2} \min_{x_i \in P_i} (c_i^\top - q^\top D_i) x_i$$

(optimal at extreme point or ray)

For any basic $\lambda_i^j : \bar{c}_i = (c_i^\top - q^\top D_i) x_i^j - r_i = 0 \Longrightarrow r_i = (c_i^\top - q^\top D_i) x_i^j \geq \min_{x_i \in P_i} (c_i^\top - q^\top D_i) x_i =: z_i$

6.2 Benders decomposition

$$\min_{x, y}\ c^\top x + f^\top y \quad \text{s.t. } Ax = b,\ Dx + By = d,\ x, y \geq 0$$

(Too many constraints, keep x in the master, eliminate y via a subproblem)

Master problem. Eliminate y via its subproblem and represent its cost by z. This significantly reduces the number of variables, but increases the number of constraints. Consider x fixed, let p be the dual variable for $By = d - Dx$, and let $\mathcal{P} = \{p \mid p^\top B \leq f^\top\}$. Denote the extreme points of $\mathcal{P}$ by p^i and the extreme rays by w^j. The full reformulation of the original problem is

$$\min_{x, z}\ c^\top x + z \quad \text{s.t. } Ax = b,\ x \geq 0,\ p^{i\top}(d - Dx) \leq z,\ w^{j\top}(d - Dx) \leq 0, \quad \forall \text{ extreme points } p^i \in \mathcal{P}, \text{ extreme rays } w^j \in \mathcal{P}$$

Restricted master. Solve using the same objective as the master problem, but only a subset of $\{p^i, w^j\}$. For a given optimal solution to the restricted problem, (x^k, z^k), check feasibility in master plroblem.

Subproblem. Form (P) $\min_{\{y|By=d-Dx^k, y\geq 0\}} f^\top y$ and (D) $\max_{\{p|p^\top B\leq f^\top\}} p^\top(d-Dx^k)$: **(i)** (D) **unbounded**: $\exists\ w^j$ with $w^{j\top}(d-Dx^*)>0 \Rightarrow$ add constraint $w^{j\top}(d-Dx)\leq 0$ to restricted problem **(ii)** (P) **finite and** $< z^k$: $\exists\ p^i$ with $p^{i\top}(d-Dx^*)>z^* \Rightarrow$ add constraint $p^{i\top}(d-Dx)\leq z$ to restricted problem **(iii)** (P) **finite and** $\geq z^k$: optimal solution to restricted problem that is feasible for the master problem $\Rightarrow$ optimal

Integer knapsack problem. Solved as a dynamic programming problem

$$F(u)=\max_a \sum_{i=1}^m p_i a_i \text{ s.t. } \sum_{i=1}^m w_i a_i \leq u,\ a\in\mathbb{Z}_+^m \qquad F(u)=\begin{cases}0 & u<\min_i w_i\\ \max_{i\in[m]}\{p_i+F(u-w_i)\} & \text{else}\end{cases}$$

7 Network flows

A tree is an undirected graph with no cycles. Properties: i) An undirected graph is a tree $\iff$ it is connected and has $|\mathcal{N}|-1$ arcs. ii) For any distinct nodes i,j in a tree, $\exists$ a unique path from $i\leftrightarrow j$. *Proofs involve deleting leaves and arcs in cycles*

A spanning tree of an undirected graph $G=(\mathcal{N},\mathcal{E})$ is a tree, $T=(\mathcal{N},\mathcal{E}_1)$, such that $\mathcal{E}_1\subseteq\mathcal{E}$. Properties: i) Let $\mathcal{E}_0\subseteq\mathcal{E}$ without any cycles $\Longrightarrow$ $\mathcal{E}_0$ can be augmented to $\mathcal{E}_1\supseteq\mathcal{E}_0$ so that $(\mathcal{N},\mathcal{E}_1)$ is a spanning tree

Network flow. Directed graph, $G=(\mathcal{N},\mathcal{A})$ with nodal supply b_i, arc capacity u_{ij}, and flow cost c_{ij}

$$\min_{f_{ij}} \sum_{(i,j)\in\mathcal{A}} c_{ij}f_{ij},\quad \text{s.t. } b_i+\sum_{j\in I(i)} f_{ji}=\sum_{j\in O(i)} f_{ij}\ \forall\ i\in\mathcal{N},\quad 0\leq f_{ij}\leq u_{ij}\ \forall\ (i,j)\in\mathcal{A}$$

Every network flow problem can be reduced to i) one with exactly one source and one sink [new outgoing (incoming) node connected to each source (sink); zero cost arcs; arc capacity equal to nodal supply], ii) one without sources or sinks [connect $t\to s$ with $u_{ts}=b_s,\ c_{ts}=-M$]

Transportation problem (**Assignment problem** sets $s_i=1,\ d_j=1,\ |\mathcal{N}_d|=|\mathcal{N}_s|$)

$$\min_{f_{ij}} \sum_{i=1}^m\sum_{j=1}^n c_{ij}f_{ij},\quad \text{s.t. } \sum_{i=1}^m f_{ij}=d_j\ \forall\ j\in\mathcal{N}_d,\quad \sum_{j=1}^j f_{ij}=s_i\ \forall\ i\in\mathcal{N}_s,\quad f_{ij}\geq 0\ \forall\ (i,j)\in\mathcal{A}$$

Shortest path. Minimum length path to target node t from source node(s) $s\in S\subseteq\mathcal{N}\setminus\{t\}$. Formulated as a network flow problem by redefining b_i. Dual lends itself to Bellman equation and Dijkstra's algorithm.

$$b_i=\begin{cases}|S| & i=t\\ +1 & i\in S\\ 0 & \text{else}\end{cases}\qquad (D):\max_{\{p_i\leq c_{ij}+p_j,\ \forall\ (i,j)\in\mathcal{A}\}} \sum_{i\in\mathcal{N}} b_i p_i \qquad (D'):\max_{\{p_i\leq c_{ij}+p_j,\ \forall\ (i,j)\in\mathcal{A},\ S=\mathcal{N}\setminus\{t\},\ p_t=0\}} \sum_{i\neq t} p_i$$

Properties: i) if $\exists$ negative length cycle, optimal cost is $-\infty$. ii) if all cycles have nonnegative length and a feasible tree solution is optimal, then the tree is a tree of shortest paths. ii) if all cycles have nonnegative length and we fix $p_n=0$, then p^* unique and p_i^* is shortest path length from node $i\to t$.

Maximum flow. Largest possible flow sent through the network from $s\to t$.

$$\max\ b_s\quad \text{s.t. } Af=b,\ b_t=-b_s,\ b_i=0\ \forall\ i\notin\{s,t\},\ 0\leq f_{ij}\leq u_{ij}\ \forall\ (i,j)\in\mathcal{A}$$

Reformulate as network flow: $\mathcal{A}'=\mathcal{A}\cup\{(t,s)\},\ c_{ij}=\begin{cases}-1 & (i,j)=(t,s)\\ 0 & \text{else}\end{cases},\ u_{ts}=\infty,\ b_i=0$

Dual: $\min \sum_{(i,j)\in\mathcal{A}} u_{ij}\theta_{ij}\quad \text{s.t. } p_i-p_j+\theta_{ij}\geq 0\ \forall\ (i,j)\in\mathcal{A},\ p_t-p_s\geq 1,\ \theta_{ij}\geq 1\ \forall\ (i,j)\in\mathcal{A}$

Minimum cut. Global cut problem creates $S \subset \mathcal{N}$ such that minimum capacity passes from $S \to S^C$. The value of the cut is $C(S) = \sum_{\{(i,j)\in\delta(S)\}} u_{ij},\ \delta(S) = \{(i,j) \mid i \in S,\ j \notin S\}$. Add constraint $(x_s, x_t) = (1, 0)$ to make Minimum s-t cut problem. Can be proved the $s \to t$ cut is the dual of the $s \to t$ Max Flow problem

$$\min_{\emptyset\subset S\subset\mathcal{N}} \sum_{(i,j)\in\delta(S)} u_{ij} \Longrightarrow \quad \min_{x,z} \sum_{(i,j)\in\mathcal{A}} u_{ij} z_{ij} \quad \text{s.t. } z_{ij} \geq x_i - x_j\ \forall\ (i,j) \in \mathcal{A},\ 0 \leq x_i, z_{ij} \leq 1 \qquad x_i = \mathbb{I}\{i \in S\},\ z_{ij} = \mathbb{I}\{i \in S,\ j \notin S\}$$

Matrix notation.

$$A \text{ s.t. } a_{ik} = \begin{cases} 1 & i \text{ starts arc } k \\ -1 & i \text{ ends arc } k \\ 0 & \text{else} \end{cases} \qquad \tilde{A} = A_{[:n-1,:]} \qquad a_i^\top f = b_i \Rightarrow Af = b \qquad Af = 0 \text{ (circulation)}$$

$\tilde{A}$ has linearly independent rows if G connected **(Proof)** G connected $\Rightarrow \exists$ spanning tree $T \subset \mathcal{A}$. Form $\tilde{A}_T$ and use unique tree solution result (below) to show $\tilde{A}_T$ singular $\Longrightarrow \tilde{A}$ has linearly independent rows.

A tree solution is a flow vector, f, constructed by (a) picking $T \subset A$ of $n-1$ arcs forming a *spanning* tree when direction is ignored, (b) setting $f_{ij} = 0\ \forall\ (i,j) \notin T$, (c) solving $\tilde{A}f = \tilde{b}$ to determine $f_{ij}\ \forall\ (i,j) \in T$. **A feasible tree solution** is a tree solution satisfying $f \geq 0$ (or $d \preceq f \preceq u$ if capacitated). **A tree solution is a unique solution: (Proof sketch)** suffice to show that $\tilde{A}_T$ is nonsingular: reorder its rows and columns to show $\tilde{A}_T$ is lower triangular with nonzero diagonals, hence nonsingular.

A flow vector is a basic solution $\iff$ it is a tree solution. (Proof $\Leftarrow$) follows immediately from above **(Proof $\Rightarrow$)** Contrapositive: Suppose not f not a tree solution and consider case when $Af = b$ (if not equal, not basic by definition). Let $S = \{(i,j) \in \mathcal{A} \mid f_{ij} \neq 0\}$. If no cycles, $\exists T \supset S$ forming a spanning tree and f is the tree solution associated with T, contradiction. If cycles, let h^C be a circulation and we have $A(f + h^C) = b$ and we observe whenever $f_{ij} = 0 \Rightarrow h^C_{ij} = 0$ and constraints active at f and $f + h^C$, so no unique solution and f not basic.

Simplex change of basis and reduced costs. For spanning tree, T, pick arc $(i,j) \notin T$ and identify cycle that is formed. Let F, B be forward and backward arcs in cycle relative to (i,j) forward. In capacitated case, assume $d_{ij} \leq f_{ij} \leq u_{ij}$.

$$\hat{f}_{k\ell} = \begin{cases} f_{k\ell} + \theta & \text{if } (k,\ell) \in F \\ f_{k\ell} - \theta & \text{if } (k,\ell) \in B \\ f_{k\ell} & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \qquad \theta^* = \begin{cases} \min_{(k,\ell)\in B} f_{k\ell} & \text{uncapacitated} \\ \min\{\min_{(k,\ell)\in B} f_{k\ell} - d_{k\ell}, \min_{(k,\ell)\in F} u_{k\ell} - f_{k\ell}\} & \text{capacitated} \end{cases}$$

$$\bar{c}_{ij} = \left(\sum_{(k,\ell)\in F} c_{k\ell} - \sum_{(k,\ell)\in B} c_{k\ell} \right) = c_{ij} - (p_i - p_j)$$

For $p^\top = c_T^\top \tilde{A}_T^{-1},\ p_n = 0$. Since $\bar{c}_T = 0$, we solve for p given the system of equations $p_i - p_j = c_{ij}\ \forall\ (i,j) \in T, p_n = 0$. Without fixing p_n, we can add a constant to all p without changing the results.

Network simplex algorithm iteration (a flow f can be improved if we can identify a cycle along which flow can be profitably pushed)

1. Start with BFS f and associated tree T. If not trivial, add new arcs with cost M to form feasible tree solution. Capacitated: also define D (where $f_{ij} = d_{ij}$) and U (where $f_{ij} = u_{ij}$)
2. Compute dual vector p by starting with $p_n = 0$ and using $p_i - p_j = c_{ij}\ \forall\ (i,j) \in T$
3. Compute $\bar{c}_{ij} = c_{ij} - (p_i - p_j)\ \forall\ (i,j) \notin T$. If $\bar{c} \geq 0 \Rightarrow x$ optimal and terminate. Else choose $(i,j) : \bar{c}_{ij} < 0$. Capacitated: $\bar{c}_{ij} \geq 0\ \forall (i,j) \in D$ and $\bar{c}_{ij} \leq 0\ \forall (i,j) \in U$. For selected (i,j), if $(i,j) \in D$, forward is $i \to j$ and if $(i,j) \in U$, forward is $j \to i$.
4. Entering arc (i,j) and arcs of T form a unique cycle. If $B = \emptyset \Longrightarrow \theta^* = \infty$ and terminate with optimal cost $-\infty$. Else choose $\theta^* = \min_{(k,\ell)\in B} f_{k\ell}$
5. New flow vector determined as above. Remove from basis the old basic variable whos new value is zero

Integrality. A integers $\Rightarrow B, B^{-1}$ integers. B^{-1} integer since B integer and lower triangular with diagonal entries $\in \{1, -1\}$. b_i (c_{ij}) integers, $\Rightarrow$ basic solution (dual basic solution) integers

8 Ellipsoid and interior point methods

8.1 Ellipsoid method

Developed to place provable polynomial bounds on linear programming problems. The original proof is for empty or full dimensional, bounded P.

Algorithm. **(Inputs)** $P = \{Ax \geq b\}$, $t^* = t(v)$ such that $Vol(P) < v \Rightarrow P = \emptyset$, $P \supset E_0 = E(x_0, r^2 I)$ **(Iteration)** (1) If $t = t^*$, $P = \emptyset$. If $x_t \in P$, $P \neq \emptyset$. Else, find i such that $a_i^\top x_t < b_i$. (2) Let $H_t = \{x \mid a_i^\top x \geq a_i^\top x_t\}$, build $E_{t+1} \supseteq H_t \cap E_t$, set $x_{t+1} \leftarrow \text{center}(E_{t+1})$ **(Polynomial time)** Each cut reduces ellipsoid volume by a fixed multiplicative factor $e^{-1/(2(n+1))}$

Relaxing requirement on boundedness. Prove lemma to establish all extreme points $x^{(i)}$ of P are contained in a bounded polyhedron, P_B. If $\text{rank}(A) = n$, P nonempty $\Longrightarrow$ P has at least one extreme point and the algorithm can be applied to P_B.

Relaxing requirement on empty or full-dimensional. Define $P_e = \{x \mid Ax \geq b - \epsilon \mathbf{1}\}$ for special ϵ and show P empty (nonempty) $\Rightarrow$ P_e empty (full-dimensional) and the algorithm can be applied to P_e.

For linear programs. Find feasible $(x, p) \in \mathcal{O} = \{(x, p) \in \mathbb{R}^{n+m} \mid Ax = b,\ x \geq 0,\ c^\top x = p^\top b, p^\top A \leq c^\top\}$. Can check feasibility of $P = \{x \mid Ax \geq b\}$ for primal feasibility. Can check feasibility of $P = \{d \mid Ad \geq 0, c^\top d = -1\}$ for unboundedness. **(Bisection)** To solve $\min c^\top x$, maintain an interval $[L, U]$ known to contain the optimal value. At each iteration, query feasibility of $P(p) = \{x \mid Ax \geq b,\ c^\top x \leq p\}$ at midpoint $p = (L + U)/2$. If P(p) is feasible, set $U \leftarrow p$, else set $L \leftarrow p$.

Separation problem. If we can solve a separation problem (decide $x \in P$ or produce d such that $d^\top x < d^\top y\ \forall\ y \in P$) for P polynomial time, we can solve an optimization problem over P in polynomial time. The converse is also true: Define $P^o = \{y \mid y^\top x \leq 1\ \forall\ x \in P\}$ and assume $0 \in P$. For $OPT(P) = \max_{x \in P} c^\top x$, (i) if $c^\top x^* \leq 1 \Longrightarrow c^\top x \leq 1\ \forall x \in P \Longrightarrow c \in P^o$. (ii) if $c^\top x^* > 1 \Longrightarrow \exists x^o \in P$ such that $c^\top x^o > 1$ and note $z^\top x^o \leq 1\ \forall z \in P^o$ so x^o separates c and P^o. Finally, $P = P^{oo}$, so $OPT(P) \iff SEP(P^o) \iff OPT(P^o) \iff SEP(P^{oo}) = SEP(P)$. Can also use Farka's lemma for separating hyperplane

8.2 Separation problem to solve exponentially many constraints

To prove solvability in poly time, define a poly-time separation problem.

Traveling salesman. Separation problem for a given $\tilde{x}$ is the min-cut problem with $u_e = \tilde{x}_e$ and directed edges, $\mathcal{A} = \{\mathcal{E}_\rightarrow, \mathcal{E}_\leftarrow\}$. Let S_0 be the minimum cut. Then if $\sum_{e \in \delta(S_0)} x_e = \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}} \tilde{x}_e z_e < 2$, $\tilde{x}_e$ infeasible and S_0 is the violated constraint.

$$\min_{x_e} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}} c_e x_e \quad \text{s.t.} \sum_{e \in \delta(\{i\})} x_e = 2\ \forall\ i \in \mathcal{N},\ x_e \in [0,1]\ \forall\ e \in \mathcal{E},\ \sum_{e \in \delta(S)} x_e \geq 2\ \forall\ S \subset \mathcal{N} \setminus \{\emptyset\} \quad (\delta(S) = \{(i,j) \mid i \in S,\ j \notin S\})$$

Min-weight edge set to intersect every $s \to t$ path. Separation problem for a given $\tilde{x}$ is the shortest path problem with $l_{ij} = \tilde{x}_{ij}$ and directed edges $\mathcal{A} = \{\mathcal{E}_\rightarrow, \mathcal{E}_\leftarrow\}$. Let K_0 be the shortest path. Then if $\sum_{e \in K_0} \tilde{x}_e < 1$, $\tilde{x}_e$ infeasible and K_0 is the violated constraint.

$$\min_{x_e} \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}} c_e x_e \qquad \text{s.t.} \sum_{e \in K} x_e \geq 1\ \forall\ K \in \mathcal{K},\ 0 \leq x_e \leq 1,\ \forall\ e \in \mathcal{E} \qquad (\mathcal{K} \text{ is the set of all } s \to t \text{ paths})$$

8.3 Interior point methods

8.3.1 Affine scaling

Approach Assume standard form $P = \{x \mid Ax = b,\ x \geq 0\}$. The interior of P is $\text{relint}(P) = \{x \mid Ax = b,\ x > 0\}$. Affine-scaling stays strictly inside this set.

Dikin ellipsoid and local LP At $x_k > 0$, the Dikin ellipsoid, $E_k = \{x \mid (x - x_k)^\top X_k^{-2}(x - x_k) \le 1\},\ X_k = \text{diag}(x_k)$, is the largest ellipsoid centered at x_k satisfying $E_k \subseteq \text{relint}(P)$. Affine scaling computes the next iterate as the minimizer of the linear objective over this ellipsoid: $x_{k+1} = \arg\min\{c^\top x \mid x \in E_k \cap \{x \mid Ax = b\}\}$. Since the boundary of E_k is strictly interior to P, x_{k+1} remains feasible and strictly positive.

Direction computation. For $d = x^{k+1} - x^k,\ x^{k+1} \in P$, we equivalently solve $\min_{\{d|Ad=0,\ d^\top X_k^{-1} d \le 1\}} c^\top d$, which has an analytical solution. Further, $c^\top d = c^\top(x^{k+1} - x^k) < 0$ so objective strictly improves. **(Interpretation)** $d_k = x_{k+1} - x_k$ is the direction of steepest feasible descent after scaling the geometry of P by the current point. The scaling X_k^{-1} normalizes coordinates so the step is "round" in the interior; this is why E_k always fits inside relint(P).

Algorithm (Iteration) -i- Compute $X_k = \text{diag}(x^k),\ p^k = (AX_k^2A^\top)^{-1}AX_K^2c,\ r^k = c - A^\top p^k$. -ii- if $r^k \ge 0,\ x^{k\top}r^k < \epsilon$, then ϵ-optimal x^k found. -iii- If $X_k^2 r^k \ge 0$, then optimal cost is unbounded. -iv- $x^{k+1} = x^k - \beta X_k^2 r^k / ||X_k r^k||_2$. Longstep variants update $||X_k r^k||_2$ with $||X_k r^k||_\infty$ or $\max_{\{X_{ki} r_i^k > 0\}} X_{ki} r_i^k$. **(Initialize)** Want $x_0 > 0$. Can be done with $\min_{\{Ax + (b - A\mathbf{1})x_{n+1} = b,\ (x, x_{n+1}) \ge 0\}} c^\top x + M x_{n+1}$ and starting point $(\mathbf{1}, 1)$.

8.3.2 Barrier method and central path

Setup. Exam questions will focus on (i) taking derivatives of the barrier Lagrangian and (ii) using $x^* \odot s^* = \mu$. Affine scaling moves quickly inside P but slows near the boundary. Barrier methods instead pick a path that stays strictly interior for all $\mu > 0$. Consider primal-dual pair $(P) : \min_{\{x|Ax=b,\ x\ge 0\}} c^\top x,\ (D) : \max_{\{p|p^\top A + s = c^\top,\ s \ge 0\}} p^\top b$. Note the duality gap identity $c^\top x - p^\top b = (s^\top + p^\top A)x - p^\top Ax = s^\top x$. If implementing, consider relaxing by expressing one variable in terms of the other ones (e.g., $a_2 x_2 = b - a_1 x_1$)

Barrier problems. Introduce logarithmic barriers on the nonnegativity constraints:

$$\min_{\{x|Ax=b\}} B_\mu(x) = c^\top x - \mu \sum_{i=1}^n \log x_i \qquad \max_{\{p,s|p^\top A + s^\top = c^\top\}} B_\mu(x) = p^\top b - \mu \sum_{j=1}^n \log s_j$$

For the barrier problems, the necessary and sufficient (KKT) conditions for optimality are

$$Ax(\mu) = b \qquad x(\mu) \ge 0 \qquad A^\top p(\mu) + s(\mu) = c \qquad s(\mu) \ge 0 \qquad x(\mu) \odot s(\mu) = \mu$$

Any $(x(\mu), p(\mu), s(\mu))$ satisfying these is optimal for the barrier problems. To check optimality, examine Lagrangian:

$$L(x, p^*) = c^\top x - p^{*\top}(Ax - b) - \mu \sum_i \log x_i = (A^\top p^* + x^*)^\top x - p^{*\top}(Ax - b) - \mu \sum_i \log x_i$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^n (s_i^* x_i - \mu \log x_i) - p^{*\top} b \quad \left(\tfrac{\partial L(x,p^*)}{\partial x_i} = 0 \iff x_i = \tfrac{\mu}{s_i^*}\right)$$

So minimizing the Lagrangian gives minimizer $x^* = x(\mu) = \mu / s^*$

Central path. The solutions $(x(\mu), s(\mu))$ parameterized by $\mu > 0$ are the **central path**. As $\mu \to 0$, $x(\mu) \to x^*$ and $s(\mu) \to s^*$ for some optimal primal-dual pair.

Exercise. Let (x_μ, p_μ) be a saddle point of $L(x, p) = c^\top x + p^\top b - p^\top Ax - \mu \sum_i \log x_i$ and show $(x_\mu, s_\mu = c - A^\top p_\mu)$ lies on the central path. **(Proof)** At a saddle point,

$\frac{\partial L(x,p)}{\partial x} = 0 \iff c_i - p^\top A_i - \frac{\mu}{x_i} = 0\ \forall\ i.$ Let $s_i := c_i - p^\top A_i$ then $s_i x_i = \mu\ \forall\ i$ and $s_i > 0\ \forall\ i$ since $\mu, x_i > 0$

$\frac{\partial L(x,p)}{\partial p} = 0 \iff b - Ax = 0 \iff Ax = b$ Together we have $\{x > 0,\ s > 0,\ p^\top A + s^\top = c^\top,\ Ax = b,\ s \odot x = \mu\}$

Which is the central path of the standard form primal.

Exercise. Suppose for $\mu = 1$ the point x_μ is feasible but not optimal, yet (x_μ, s_μ) converge as $\mu \to 0$. Show (i) some index i satisfies $x_i^* = 0$, (ii) for that i, $\lim_{\mu \to 0} x_{\mu,i}/\mu > 0$.

(Proof i) If $x_i^* > 0\ \forall\ i$, then strict complementarity gives $s_i^* = 0\ \forall\ i$. Then any feasible x satisfies $x \odot s^* = 0$, so all feasible x are optimal — a contradiction to x_μ feasible but not optimal. **(Proof ii)** For the index i with $x_i^* = 0$, strict complementarity gives $s_i^* > 0$. From $x_{\mu,i} s_{\mu,i} = \mu$, $\frac{x_{\mu,i}}{\mu} = \frac{1}{s_{\mu,i}} \to \frac{1}{s_i^*} > 0$.